

## Part 1. Simulation Evidence

I chose these three because each maps to a core sysadmin duty: supporting users, deploying infrastructure, and protecting it.

### 1. Datacom Service Desk

Task: Act as a first-line service desk agent for a managed services client. Triage incoming tickets, work through a network outage, and decide when to escalate.

Tools and skills: Ticketing system, knowledge base, ITIL escalation process, prioritising by impact and urgency, written customer updates, documentation.

What I produced: Prioritised ticket queue, escalation of the outage to the correct team, and clear status updates for the client.

NICE role: Technical Support Specialist. The role centres on being the first point of contact, resolving issues, and escalating what is beyond your tier, which is what this task asked for.

Evidence:



### 2. Datacom Introduction to Cloud

Task: Help WCD Bank, a fictional client moving from on-premises data centres to the cloud, by registering an application and enabling a function for the implementation phase.

Tools and skills: Git (configured locally), a GitHub repository, a GitHub Actions workflow, command line, attention to detail.

What I produced: A working repository with an automated workflow.

NICE role: Systems Administrator, with some overlap into Systems Developer. Setting up repositories and automating deployment steps is routine sysadmin work.

Evidence:



### 3. Datacom Cyber Security Operations

Task: Investigate a simulated data breach at a mid-sized company, then complete a risk assessment.

Tools and skills: Breach impact analysis, identifying exploited weaknesses, listing and ranking assets, threats and likelihood, report writing.

What I produced: A written report covering the attack, the vulnerabilities involved, the legal, financial and reputational impact, and recommendations. The second part was a prioritised risk assessment.

NICE role: Cyber Defense Incident Responder for the breach analysis.

Evidence:

DATAKOM



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# Cameron Phillips

## Cyber Security Operations Job Simulation

Certificate of Completion  
October 7th, 2026

Over the period of October 2026, Cameron Phillips has completed practical tasks in:

Introduction to Cyber Security  
Cybersecurity risk assessment

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### Part 2. Recommendations and executive summary

#### Simulation: Service Desk

| # | Recommendation                                                                                              | Effort        | Owner                    | Trade-off                                                                             |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Set written rules for ranking tickets by impact and urgency, so an outage always outranks routine requests. | Low           | Service desk lead        | Staff have less room to use judgment.                                                 |
| 2 | Define when and how to escalate, with named contacts and time limits.                                       | Low to medium | Service delivery manager | Some tickets will be escalated that did not need to be, which costs specialists time. |

|   |                                                                                    |        |                                       |                                                          |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| 3 | Use ready-made update templates sent to clients at set intervals during an outage. | Medium | Service desk lead with communications | Frequent updates take time away from fixing the problem. |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|

## Executive summary

Decision needed: Approve a small set of changes to how we handle IT outages. They need about two weeks of staff time and no new spending.

Why it matters: When a network outage hits, every minute costs the client money and trust. In the exercise, the main risk was not a lack of technical skill. It was confusion over what to handle first, who to pass it to, and what to tell the client. Without clear rules, the most serious problems can sit in the queue next to routine requests, and clients are left without news

What we recommend:

1. Agree on what comes first: outages that stop many people from working are handled before anything else
2. Make handoffs clear: Staff will know exactly who to call and how long to wait before passing a problem on.
3. Keep clients informed: We send short, regular updates, even when the answer is “still working on it”.

What it costs: Mostly staff time, the main trade off is that some issues will be passed on that could have been solved locally, but that is a small price for faster outage response.

Next step: Please approve a pilot so the service desk lead can put these in place and report back after one month.

## Part 3. Professional practice decision

1. Being honest about the breach (Cyber Security Operations): When writing the breach report I had to state what the evidence showed about the extent of the breach and its likely business impact. It would have been tempting to soften the legal and reputational risk to make the client look better, or to exaggerate it to sound more urgent. I reported what the evidence supported and no more.

ISC2 Code of Ethics, Canon 2: Act honorably, honestly, justly, responsibly, and legally.

2. Staying in scope on escalation (Service Desk): As a first-line agent, I was expected to fix what was in my remit and pass the network outage to the proper team under the ITIL process. Trying to fix it myself without the access or expertise could have made things worse and delayed the right people. Escalating was the competent choice.

ISC2 Code of Ethics, Canon 3: Provide diligent and competent service to principals.